PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
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Memorandum

Date: Wednesday, May 27, 2026

TO: PPS Policy Committee

FROM: Will Fernandez, Director Racial Equity and Social Justice

SUBJECT: Racial Equity and Social Justice (RESJ) Community Advisory Committee Appointments

The attached draft policy, *Protecting Student Access and Safe Schools*, is being brought forward for Policy Committee discussion and consideration on an expedited basis. The purpose of this policy is to establish a clear districtwide framework for protecting student access to education, ensuring safe and supportive school environments, and aligning PPS practices with newly enacted Oregon law related to immigration enforcement in schools.

This draft policy aligns with both Oregon Laws 2026 (SB 1538) and Oregon Laws 2026 (HB 4079). HB 4079 requires that school districts adopt conforming policies by September 30, 2026.

SB 1538 requires Oregon school districts to adopt policies and procedures related to immigration enforcement interactions, student privacy protections, staff training, access to education regardless of immigration status, and nondiscrimination protections connected to immigration status. HB 4079 establishes additional requirements related to notification procedures when federal immigration authorities are present on or near school property for immigration enforcement purposes. The draft policy incorporates both of these statutory requirements throughout the policy's sections related to student access, immigration enforcement response protocols, notice requirements, staff training, and protection of student information.

Importantly, this policy does not create an entirely new operational structure for PPS. PPS began developing guidance in 2019 and in this past year, PPS has significantly expanded and refined guidance, protocols, communication tools, safety procedures, and community response resources related to immigration enforcement scenarios and student safety. This includes the PPS Immigration Enforcement Toolkit referenced throughout the draft policy.

This draft is being shared for Policy Committee discussion, feedback, and consideration regarding next steps for formal Board review and adoption before September 30, 2026.